8.7 Rights of a Girl Child

To achieve true women empowerment, girl children rights are important. This is because girls of today are the women of tomorrow. It is the role of social welfare organizations to support for the eradication of female infanticide and women empowerment. Some yardsticks of women empowerment are:

Helping women to develop a positive self-image and increase their confidence level.

Enabling them to develop the ability to think critically.

Ensuring that they have equal participation in decision making, whether it's in the family or at the community level.

Providing economic independence to women.

Why Girl Children Should be Given Rights

The role of education is extremely important here and goes a long way in empowering women. Girl children need to be sent to school, provided quality and holistic education. Numerous benefits come with educating girls the right way. Educated girls are able to take the right decisions in life. For example, when an educated girl falls sick, she will have better understanding and awareness to avail proper healthcare services. At the same time, a society in which girls are educated will see less child marriages, decreased levels of poverty and heightened participation of women in socio-economic processes. Educating a girl has far-reaching impacts. When a woman is educated, an entire generation benefits from it. Therefore ensuring the rights and privilege of a girl child pave way for development of a community.

Literally meaning 'Educate the Girl Child, Save the Girl Child' the Beti Padhao, Beti Bachao Scheme is an ambitious scheme of the Government of India which is intended to generate massive awareness, improvement of quality of welfare services for females and helping them (girls and women) access these services better. It was Introduced in October 2014, It is a joint initiative of three important Central Government ministries – the Ministry of Women and Child Development, Ministry of Health and Family Welfare and Ministry of Human Resource Development.It is therefore imperative that both government and non-government organizations work in cohesion to spread the message of saving and educating the girl child.



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